



TUESDAY

MARCH 18, 2025
RAMADAN 18, 1446

GULF NEWS

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UAE public sector Eid holidays announced

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The Federal Authority for Government Human Resources (FAHR) yesterday issued a circular announcing that the Eid Al Fitr holiday for the federal government sector will be observed from 1st to 3rd Shawwal 1446 AH, with official work resuming on 4th Shawwal.

In the event that the fast-ing month of Ramadan concludes with 30 days, the 30th of Ramadan shall be observed as an additional public holiday, thereby extending the Eid Al Fitr break.

On this occasion, the Authority extended its congratulations to the UAE government, its people, residents, and the Arab and Islamic nations, wishing them continued prosperity and well-being.



IFTAR 18:32

Fajr	05:08	Shuruq	06:21
Dhuhr	12:30	Asr	15:54
Maghrib	18:32	Isha	19:46

ISMAK 04:58

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah

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Dubai free zone businesses can now operate in mainland

NEW REGULATION TO ENHANCE BUSINESS FLEXIBILITY AND DRIVE INVESTMENT

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Dubai has introduced a major policy shift that allows free zone businesses to expand their operations into mainland Dubai.

In his capacity as Chairman of Dubai Executive Council, Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, issued a new regulation that permits several free zone establishments to conduct business outside their designated zones, provided they obtain the necessary approvals from the Dubai Department of Economy and Tourism (DET).

This move aligns with the Dubai Economic Agenda (D33), which aims to double Dubai's economy by 2033 and establish it as one of the world's top three economic cities. The new resolution is expected to enhance business flexibility, drive investment, and create more opportunities for companies looking to expand their market reach.

DIFC institutions excluded

Under the resolution, any company licenced by a free zone authority, except financial institutions in the Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC), can now operate in mainland Dubai after obtaining the mandated licences or permits from the DET.

Businesses can either establish a branch in mainland Dubai with a DET-issued licence, valid for one year and renewable, or apply for a permit to conduct specific activities outside the free

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR BUSINESSES

- Businesses can apply for a DET-issued licence to operate a branch in mainland Dubai or obtain a permit for specific activities. Licences will be valid for one year and renewable.
- Free zone companies can now access Dubai's thriving mainland market, significantly widening their customer base.
- The resolution fosters innovation, job creation, and economic activity by allowing businesses to operate seamlessly across Dubai's economic landscape.
- Companies must maintain separate financial records for mainland and free zone operations and comply with all federal and local regulations.



- The new regulation permits several free zone establishments to conduct business outside their designated zones, provided they obtain the necessary approvals from DET.

zone. This development provides companies with greater flexibility in expanding their operations while ensuring regulatory compliance.

Benefits for businesses

Allowing free zone businesses to operate in mainland Dubai brings several advantages. It enables them to tap into a wider customer base and expand their market reach, fostering business growth and investment opportunities. The resolution simplifies the licensing process, making it easier for companies to navigate regulatory requirements while maintaining the benefits of free

zone operations. Additionally, it strengthens Dubai's position as a global business hub by encouraging increased economic activity, job creation, and innovation. By providing regulatory clarity and a more integrated business environment, the new framework supports both local entrepreneurs and international investors looking to establish a presence in Dubai.

Compliance and next steps

Companies operating outside free zones must comply with federal and local regulations and maintain separate financial records for mainland and free zone

activities. If businesses wish to operate beyond Dubai, they must secure additional permits from the relevant authorities.

DET, in coordination with licensing authorities, will release a list of approved economic activities within six months. Existing businesses operating outside free zones must comply with the new rules within a year, with a possible one-year extension if needed.

This resolution reinforces Dubai's commitment to business-friendly policies, making it easier for companies to thrive, expand, and contribute to the city's growing economy.

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Trump says Iran 'will be held responsible' for Houthi attacks

'Every shot fired by the Houthis will be looked upon as a shot fired by Iran'

WASHINGTON

President Donald Trump yesterday declared he will hold Iran directly responsible for any future attacks by Yemen's Iran-backed Houthi rebels, who have targeted multiple US and other foreign ships in the Red Sea.

"Every shot fired by the Houthis will be looked upon, from this point forward, as being a shot fired from the weapons and leadership of Iran, and Iran will be held responsible, and suffer the consequences," Trump posted on his Truth Social platform.

Earlier yesterday, the Houthis said they had attacked the USS Harry S. Truman aircraft carrier group twice within 24 hours.

sequences," Trump posted on his Truth Social platform.

Meanwhile, huge crowds joined protests in rebel-controlled Yemen yesterday after deadly US strikes killed dozens and sparked fears of a new cycle of violence in the conflict-torn country.

There were also large crowds in Saada, birthplace of the Iran-backed Houthi movement, and demonstrations in

Dhamar, Hodeida and Amran, footage from the rebels' Al Masirah TV station showed.

Deadly strikes

The protests came after the first US strikes on Yemen under President Donald Trump, aimed at ending the Houthis' Red Sea harassment campaign, killed 53 people and wounded 98 on Saturday.

The rebels launched scores of attacks on ships in the vital route during the Gaza war, claiming solidarity with the Palestinians.

Earlier yesterday, they said they had attacked the USS Harry S. Truman aircraft carrier group twice within 24 hours. There was no comment from the United States. — AFP

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